ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 20 × 1 = 20

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a source of future income	Rain meant a good harvest and money.
2	**(b)** to show global respect for the change in South Africa	It highlights international support.
3	**(a)** fear of failure	He doubted his wings.
4	**(d)** a confidant	She wanted a trusted listener.
5	**(b)** Portuguese culture	Words from the Portuguese period.
6	**(b)** understood the animal and kept his patience	His patience and affection for Mij are clear.
7	**(a)** respect and recognition	She wants to be treated as an adult.
8	**(d)** teaching through experience	She finds the truth by herself.
9	**(a)** he suspects something unusual	He wonders why Lomov dressed up.
10	**(d)** the contrast between Mrs Pumphrey's fuss and the simple truth about Tricki	Over-indulgence versus plain facts.
11	**(d)** simple and trusting	Easy prey.
12	**(d)** he saw wit and calm used instead of weapons	Experience corrected his romantic image.
13	**(b)** he was disciplined even in crime and driven by his hobby	A restrained, hobby-driven thief.
14	**(b)** invisibility could not be switched off easily in daily life	Practical limits of the power.
15	**(d)** it linked Richard to a real research project	Connected him with an expert.
16	**(a)** comparing her life with a dream of wealth	She felt entitled to luxury.
17	**(a)** undervalued girls with physical flaws	Social prejudice.
18	**(b)** they take simple nonsense verses as deep warnings	Literal reading.
19	**(a)** joy can come from unexpected sources	Irony.
20	**(a)** personal experience of craving	He has felt it.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 2 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	To show how much Lencho had to lose (1) and to create contrast with the hail disaster later (1).	1+1
22	It marked the end of apartheid (1) and the start of a democratic South Africa for all (1).	1+1
23	It forces him to take the leap (1) that overcomes his fear (1).	1+1
24	She is surrounded by family and friends (1) yet cannot share her deepest feelings with anyone (1).	1+1
25	The baker is described as prosperous (1) and bread is needed for every celebration (1).	1+1
26	So that the otter could breathe (1) and travel safely (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
27	The ripe field and flowers show promise (1). Lencho compares raindrops to coins (1). This makes the hail more shocking (1).	1+1+1
28	He speaks of the ceremony as the end of a long dark period (1). He calls apartheid a human disaster that wounded the nation (1). The presence of the world's leaders confirms that a new era has begun (1).	1+1+1
29	He shows the young bird shaking on the edge (1). His family are flying and he is left behind (1). The sea below looks vast and frightening (1).	1+1+1
30	She admits she has no real friend (1). She believes no one would care about her private views (1). She hopes the diary will listen (1).	1+1+1

31	He supplied fresh bread twice a day (1). His arrival was a community ritual (1). His products were part of weddings and festivals (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He loved Mij and wanted him close, but the risks were real (1). A stronger box and notice to the airline would have helped (1). Therefore the decision was affectionate rather than prudent (1).	1+1+1
32	Valli watches the bus daily (1). She plans and waits for the day (1). Her excitement grows till she boards (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He did not argue (1). He set a task that revealed truth (1). The method respected her feelings (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

6 × 5 = 30

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
33	Hardworking: tends his field (1). Faithful: writes to God (1). Naive: expects to be answered directly (1). Ungrateful: calls helpers crooks (1). Conclusion: sympathetic but flawed (1).	2+2+1
34	He defines freedom as respecting and enhancing the freedom of others (1). He says the oppressor too is not free (1). He honours the collective struggle of many people (1). The call to build a new society indicates a duty on all (1). Hence freedom is not a privilege but a responsibility to be nurtured by everyone (1).	2+2+1
35	Starts as timid and dependent (1). Fear of falling (1). Hunger acts as a push (1). He discovers his strength (1). Ends confident and joyful (1).	2+2+1
36	Lonely: wants a confidant (1). Witty: the duck poem (1). Honest: speaks freely (1). Resilient: makes light of punishment (1). Sensitive and thoughtful overall (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Sound of bamboo (1). Smell of bread (1). Sight of baker and basket (1). Taste of bol (1). These details create nostalgia (1).	2+2+1
37	He treats the escape as comedy rather than disaster (1). The passengers' alarm adds fun (1). Yet each scene shows his tender concern for Mij (1). Understatement keeps the tone gentle (1). The result is a warm portrait of a man and his pet (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Starts curious and eager (1). Plans bravely (1). Feels proud as Madam (1). Is shocked by the cow (1). Returns thoughtful (1).	2+2+1
38	Denial and grief (1). The Buddha's task (1). The search (1). Realisation (1). Peace and burial (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Definition of farce (1). Exaggerated characters (1). Absurd quarrels (1). Fast pace and physical comedy (1). Happy ending (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTER KEY

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 20 × 1 = 20

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** soft and stealthy movement	Padded paws.
2	**(a)** guide-book instructions	Mock manual.
3	**(b)** general reflection on loss	Universal.
4	**(b)** contrast outer commands and inner dreams	Structure.
5	**(d)** express longing for freedom	Symbolic.
6	**(c)** soft and silent	Silent.
7	**(a)** rhyme and sound alike	Sound play.
8	**(c)** warning to a beautiful young woman	Warning.
9	**(c)** the helper is accused of cheating	Irony of situation.
10	**(b)** stress a solemn vow	It strengthens the promise.
11	**(c)** the sense of risk	An old plane in a storm is dangerous.
12	**(b)** firm but fair-minded	He could appreciate a joke.
13	**(b)** river rafting and trekking	Adventure sports.
14	**(c)** it shows closeness	Nicknames show affection.
15	**(c)** She notices the scenery and people	Eager observation.
16	**(b)** It addresses the sorrow of all mortals	Universal.
17	**(c)** He is shy and nervous but quarrelsome	Mixed nature.
18	**(a)** too much love expressed as too much food	Overfeeding.
19	**(d)** relative clause	Who-clause describes Hari.
20	**(d)** danger can be ended in an instant by wit	Quick resolution.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 2 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	It shows Valli's pride (1) and sets a humorous, respectful tone (1).	1+1
22	She was in no state to accept (1) so he gave her a task to find the truth herself (1).	1+1
23	Each time Lomov begins, a quarrel starts (1) so the main purpose is postponed (1).	1+1
24	He is tactful and kind (1) and the owner's happiness matters more than correcting a harmless mistake (1).	1+1
25	He was friendly and trusting (1) and unaware that Hari was a thief (1).	1+1
26	To contrast his appearance with his ability (1) and to surprise the reader by his clever action (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
27	Lomov starts to speak (1). A new quarrel arises (1). The repeated delay is funny (1).	1+1+1
28	Letters from the dog (1). The title irony (1). Mrs Pumphrey's exaggerated fuss (1).	1+1+1
29	Hari expected suspicion but found faith. This shocked him and made him feel valued for the first time. The memory of that trust stopped him at the station and led him back.	1+1+1
30	Ausable looks heavy and ordinary but acts with great skill. The contrast between look and ability makes him memorable. It surprises both Fowler and the reader.	1+1+1
31	A burglar who sneezes and helps a stranger is comic. The thief being robbed adds irony. The mild tone and ending in the library keep the story light.	1+1+1
	OR: It combines two ideas that do not belong together: footprints and no feet. This puzzle creates curiosity. It also prepares us for a story of mystery.	1+1+1
32	The chapter begins with childhood collecting and shows tagging monarchs. Then it describes school-level experiments and later research at Harvard. Each stage builds on the previous one.	1+1+1

	OR: He shows great sacrifice for a necklace. The reader learns only at the end that it was paste. The gap between effort and result creates deep irony.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

6 × 5 = 30

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
33	Rich widow (1). Loving but foolish (1). Over-feeds and fusses (1). Generous with gifts (1). Gratitude at the end (1).	2+2+1
34	Hari begins as a cunning thief (1). Anil offers kindness and trust (1). Hari's conscience troubles him (1). He returns the money (1). He wants to study; he is reformed (1).	2+2+1
35	Max has weapon and strength (1). Ausable has calm and wit (1). The balcony lie traps Max (1). Max defeats himself (1). Conclusion: intelligence wins (1).	2+2+1
36	Humour in Horace's character (1). Irony of the thief tricked (1). The woman's cleverness (1). Moral: do not trust blindly (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Griffin's discovery (1). His misuse (1). Harm to others and himself (1). Duty of scientists (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
37	Define the statement (1). Early interests and collecting (1). Support from mother and mentor (1). Experiments and prizes (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Define vanity (1). Mathilde's longing for luxury (1). Borrowing the necklace (1). Consequences of loss (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
38	Statement (1). Bholi's condition before school (1). The teacher's role (1). Her change and refusal (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Define satire (1). Pompous leader (1). Misreading of books (1). Folly of planning war (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERKEY

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 20 × 1 = 20

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Horace had planned the robbery for weeks.	had + V3.
2	**(d)** Griffin's misuse led to people hunting him	Cause-effect.
3	**(c)** early encouragement	Encouragement.
4	**(d)** claiming status one does not have	Pretension.
5	**(b)** he valued money over the bride	Greed.
6	**(d)** mistakes drive the plot	Errors.
7	**(a)** healing power of nature	Nature heals.
8	**(c)** common differing opinions	General views.
9	**(a)** his predatory instinct even in captivity	Instinct.
10	**(c)** catchy and light	Singable.
11	**(a)** respect for the boy's privacy	He stays away.
12	**(d)** children should always obey	Challenge.
13	**(c)** confinement of living things	Theme.
14	**(d)** descriptive	Descriptive.
15	**(a)** Custard's looks and his nature	Contrast.
16	**(d)** love for the hair would vanish and test the lover	Test.
17	**(d)** Despite the hail, Lencho kept his faith.	'Despite' is followed directly by a noun.
18	**(c)** against	Fight against.
19	**(a)** eager	Reluctant = unwilling.
20	**(a)** cheerfully	It modifies the verb.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 2 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	He is polite and kindly (1) and her confident story gave no reason for doubt, yet a sensible thief would have been suspicious (1).	1+1
22	Through footprints and the reactions of others (1) so that the reader feels his presence (1).	1+1
23	To show that scientific interest begins early (1) and that collecting taught observation and classification (1).	1+1
24	It establishes her desire for luxury (1) which drives her later choices and the loss of the necklace (1).	1+1
25	To show how low she stood in society (1) so that her later courage appears all the more impressive (1).	1+1
26	The Historian speaks from a later age (1) and gives the comic story a historical air, adding irony (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
27	Education gives Bholi speech, knowledge and confidence. She can understand her worth. It lets her decide against a greedy marriage.	1+1+1
28	Humour comes from the comic misreadings and exaggerated pomp. Satire uses this to criticise war-making and blind confidence. Together they entertain and teach.	1+1+1
29	Crow and hemlock suggest gloom (1). They bring cheer (1). The reversal is the poem's twist (1).	1+1+1
30	Presents two views (1). Gives personal evidence (1). Ends with a balanced conclusion (1).	1+1+1
31	The present is dull confinement (1). The imagined past is wild and free (1). The contrast arouses pity (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Advice looks helpful (1). It works only after attack (1). The contrast produces humour (1).	1+1+1
32	The ball is merry (1). The boy then stands in sorrow (1). The sudden change shows how fragile joy is (1).	1+1+1

	OR: The adult's voice commands (1). Amanda's inner voice dreams (1). Together they create dramatic contrast (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

6 × 5 = 30

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
33	Crow and hemlock as gloomy symbols (1). Snow as purity (1). Irony of cheer from gloom (1). Effect on mood (1). Overall meaning (1).	2+2+1
34	Symbols fire and ice (1). Understatement (1). Personal voice (1). Warning (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
35	Cage vs jungle (1). Quiet vs rage (1). Present vs imagined (1). Language (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
36	Parody (1). Irony (1). Exaggeration (1). Wordplay (1). Rhyme and rhythm (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Event (1). Boy's grief (1). Poet's reflection (1). Money (1). Growth (1).	2+2+1
37	Brackets (1). Commands (1). Dreams (1). Contrast (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Personified trees (1). Symbol of room and forest (1). Moon image (1). Poet's role (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
38	Subject fog (1). Cat metaphor (1). Language (1). Mood (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Names (1). Exaggeration (1). Irony (1). Rhyme (1). Twist (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND